source of support. I wondered if there was something wrong with the way in which I managed my time. At this stage, Prof. Sarabhai brought a French visitor to our work centre to point out the problem to me. This gentleman was Prof. Curien, President of CNES (Centre Nationale de Etudes Spatiales), our counterpart in France. They were then developing the Diamont launch vehicles. Prof. Curien was a thorough professional. Together, Prof. Sarabhai and Prof. Curien helped me set a target. While they discussed the means by which I could reach it, they also cautioned me about the possibilities of failure. While I arrived at a better awareness of Stage IV problems through the supportive counsel ing of Prof. Curien, Prof. Sarabhai's catalytic intervention led Prof. Curien to reinterpret his own progress in the Diamont programme.

Prof. Curien advised Prof. Sarabhai to relieve me of al the minor jobs which posed little chal enge and to give me more opportunities for achievement. He was so impressed by our wel -planned efforts that he inquired if we could make the Diamont's fourth stage. I recal how this brought a subtle smile to Prof. Sarabhai's face.

As a matter of fact, the Diamont and SLV airframes